NCL Fall 2025 Team Game Scouting Report

Dear Sean Cassidy (Team "Cyb3rPum@s"),

Thank you for participating in the National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Season! Our goal is to prepare the next generation of cybersecurity professionals, and your participation is helping achieve that goal.

The NCL was founded in May 2011 to provide an ongoing virtual training ground for collegiate students to develop, practice, and validate their cybersecurity skills in preparation for further learning, industry certifications, and career readiness. The NCL scenario-based challenges were designed around performance-based exam objectives of CompTIA certifications and are aligned to the National Initiative for Cybersecurity Education (NICE) Cybersecurity Workforce Framework published by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

As you look to a future career in cybersecurity, we hope you find this report to be valuable in both validating skills and identifying areas for improvement across the nine NCL skills categories. You can use this NCL Scouting Report to:

- Validate your skills to employers in any job application or professional portfolio;
- Show case your achievements and strengths by including the Score Card view of your performance as part of your résumé or simply sharing the validation link so that others may view the detailed version of this report.

The NCL Fall 2025 Season had 8,520 students/players and 538 faculty/coaches from more than 490 two- and four-year schools & 200 high schools across all 50 U.S. states registered to play. The Individual Game Capture the Flag (CTF) event took place from October 24 through October 26. The Team Game CTF event took place from November 7 through November 9. The games were conducted in real-time for students across the country. You were in the Experienced Students Bracket, consisting of students enrolled in advanced degrees or hold extensive industry working experience.

NCL is powered by Cyber Skyline's cloud-based skills evaluation platform. Cyber Skyline hosted the scenario-driven cybersecurity challenges for players to compete and track their progress in real-time.

To validate this report, please access: cyberskyline.com/report/CH3GX258G3FD

Congratulations for your participation in the NCL Fall 2025 Team Game! We hope you will continue to develop your knowledge and skills and make meaningful contributions as part of the Information Security workforce!

Dr. David Zeichick
NCL Commissioner

POWERED BY CYBER SKYLINE

NATIONAL CYBER LEAGUE SCORE CARD

NCL FALL 2025 TEAM GAME

EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

122ND PLACE OUT OF 454

PERCENTILE
74TH

YOUR TOP CATEGORIES

FORENSICS	SCANNING & RECONNAISSANCE	PASSWORD CRACKING
77TH PERCENTILE	77TH PERCENTILE	76TH PERCENTILE

56.5%
ACCURACY

Average: 69.9%

cyberskyline.com/report
ID: CH3GX258G3FD

NCL Fall 2025 Team Game

The NCL Team Game is designed for student players nationwide to compete in realtime in the categories listed below. The Team Game promotes camaraderie and evaluates the collective technical cybersecurity skills of the team members.

122 ND PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

1790 POINTS OUT OF 3000
PERFORMANCE SCORE

56.5% ACCURACY

60.1% COMPLETION

74th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 1852.0 Points

Average: 69.9%

Average: 61.4%

Cryptography

180 POINTS OUT OF 340

61.1% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 61.1%

Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

Enumeration & Exploitation

180 POINTS OUT OF 390

45.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 27.3%

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

Forensics

170 POINTS OUT OF 300

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 61.5%

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

Log Analysis

205 POINTS OUT OF 300

45.2% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 70.0%

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

Network Traffic Analysis

205 POINTS OUT OF 300

55.6% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 71.4%

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

Open Source Intelligence

190 POINTS OUT OF 370

45.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 66.7%

Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

Password Cracking

165 POINTS OUT OF 325

88.9% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 61.5%

Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

Scanning & Reconnaissance

250 POINTS OUT OF 300

66.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 87.5%

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

Web Application Exploitation

145 POINTS OUT OF 275

87.5% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 53.8%

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

Note: Survey module (100 points) was excluded from this report.

Cryptography Module

Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

125 TH PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

180 POINTS OUT OF 340
PERFORMANCE SCORE

61.1% ACCURACY

61.1% COMPLETION

73rd Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 201.0 Points

Average: 64.8%

Average: 64.5%

Steganography (Easy)

30 POINTS OUT OF 30

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Decode Whitespace, Trevanion, and Baconian Ciphers.

Layer Cake (Easy)

60 POINTS OUT OF 60

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Decode a plaintext string obfuscated by multiple layers of character encoding.

Cryptic Cultures (Easy)

45 POINTS OUT OF 45

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Decode ciphers from popular culture.

Quagmire (Medium)

0 POINTS OUT OF 60

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Reverse engineer the keys of a Quagmire II cipher through a known-plaintext attack.

Crypto Twister (Medium)

45 POINTS OUT OF 75

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 66.7%

Exploit Mersenne Twister PRNG on a Rust TCP server.

Chaos Theory (Hard)

0 POINTS OUT OF 70

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Use entropy analysis and cryptographic fuzzing to decrypt a binary file.

Enumeration & Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

112 TH PLACE OUT OF 454 EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK	180 POINTS OUT OF 390 PERFORMANCE SCORE	45.0% ACCURACY	27.3% COMPLETION
76th Experienced Students Percentile	Average: 193.7 Points	Average: 55.5%	Average: 39.3%

Cooking Lunch (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100 | 30.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Reverse engineer the required input of an obfuscated program.

Poliwhirl (Medium)

50 POINTS OUT OF 100 | 75.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 75.0%

Reverse engineer an optimized RISC-V binary.

Cooking Dinner (Hard)

20 POINTS OUT OF 50 | 50.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 50.0%

Reverse engineer the functionality of an obfuscated program from the given output.

MAINFRAME - Access the Mainframe

10 POINTS OUT OF 140 | 50.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 8.3%

Perform program execution, backdooring, and buffer overflow attacks on z/OS mainframes.

Forensics Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

105 TH PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

170 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

50.0% ACCURACY

61.5% COMPLETION

77th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 159.2 Points

Average: 60.4%

Average: 51.0%

Colorwork (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Use manual and/or automated tools to find information hidden within an image.

Technical Difficulties (Medium)

30 POINTS OUT OF 100

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 66.7%

Manually apply an incremental patch to restore data from a corrupted backup archive.

Split Keys (Hard)

20 POINTS OUT OF 75

33.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 40.0%

Recover artifacts from a process dump and decrypt the hidden message.

MAINFRAME - Hack the Gibson

20 POINTS OUT OF 25

60.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 75.0%

Decode XMI files and crack RACF hashes to get mainframe logins.

Log Analysis Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

112 TH PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

205 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

45.2% ACCURACY

70.0% COMPLETION

76th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 195.7 Points

Average: 60.0%

Average: 67.7%

LO(L)G (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze the attack chain of ClickFix family malware in a Sysmon xml file.

JSON Query (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

41.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Parse and analyze Suricata eve.json logs to identify C2 activity.

Chronicles of XP (Hard)

5 POINTS OUT OF 100

33.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 14.3%

Parse a custom binary file based on the provided specs to decode the data.

Network Traffic Analysis Module

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

132 ND PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

205 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

55.6%
ACCURACY

71.4%
COMPLETION

71st Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 188.2 Points

Average: 61.8%

Average: 64.0%

Snakes and Packets (Easy)

85 POINTS OUT OF 100

35.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 83.3%

Analyze a packet capture to detect data exfiltration through SMTP.

An Offer You Can't Refuse (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

88.9% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Identify specific characteristics of a rogue DHCP server from a packet capture.

Patient Zero (Hard)

20 POINTS OUT OF 100

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 28.6%

Examine and parse a custom protocol used to transmit patient information, similar to HL7.

Open Source Intelligence Module

Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

161 ST PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

190 POINTS OUT OF 370
PERFORMANCE SCORE

45.0% ACCURACY

66.7% COMPLETION

65th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 267.0 Points

Average: 69.3%

Average: 80.8%

Rules of Conduct (Easy)

30 POINTS OUT OF 30

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Introductory challenge on acceptable conduct during NCL.

Cruise Ship (Easy)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50

27.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Identify and locate a cruise ship by cross-referencing its itinerary with an EXIF timestamp.

Finding Room 47 (Easy)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Use OSINT to research clues from an old puzzle book.

Tooling (Medium)

30 POINTS OUT OF 60

20.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 50.0%

Perform OSINT on an image using EXIF data and online research to find key information.

Still Controversial? (Medium)

10 POINTS OUT OF 80

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 16.7%

Investigate publicly available information on a company's data breach.

Guiding Light (Hard)

20 POINTS OUT OF 100

50.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 50.0%

Triangulate a location using EXIF timestamp data and shadow lengths.

Password Cracking Module

Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

112 TH PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

165 POINTS OUT OF 325
PERFORMANCE SCORE

88.9%
ACCURACY

61.5%
COMPLETION

76th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 173.9 Points

Average: 85.2%

Average: 58.7%

Hash it Out (Easy)

40 POINTS OUT OF 40

80.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Generate hashes for passwords with the MD5, NTLM, SHA1 and SHA256 hashing algorithms.

Zeitgeist (Easy)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Crack MD5 hashed passwords with a wordlist.

Peninsula-Password (Medium)

15 POINTS OUT OF 50

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 33.3%

Crack NTLM Windows Passwords using the EFF's wordlists.

DBs (Medium)

10 POINTS OUT OF 70

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 40.0%

Crack an NTLMv2 hash and Blake2b password to decrypt an MSSQL database.

Règles (Medium)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Crack modified passwords from a leaked database using Hashcat's rule attack mode.

Magic (Hard)

0 POINTS OUT OF 65

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Crack passwords by creating a wordlist, augmenting permutation rules using known password complexity requirements.

Scanning & Reconnaissance Module

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

108 TH PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

250 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

66.7% ACCURACY

87.5% COMPLETION

77th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 204.7 Points

Average: 69.3%

Average: 69.8%

Open (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Scan a server to determine information about running services.

Git A Gander (Medium)

50 POINTS OUT OF 100

30.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 60.0%

Manually scan a code repository for secrets in its commit history.

Walk (Hard)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Scan a server to discover an SNMP service and use nmap scripts and default credentials to reveal sensitive information.

Web Application Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

151 ST PLACE OUT OF 454
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

145 POINTS OUT OF 275
PERFORMANCE SCORE

87.5% ACCURACY

53.8% COMPLETION

67th Experienced Students Percentile

Average: 185.4 Points

Average: 75.4%

Average: 62.5%

Something's Fishy (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Find and exploit a client-side validated function to bypass checks and set an arbitrary score.

Picto (Medium)

0 POINTS OUT OF 100

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Exploit open-box XSS on unsanitized rendered output in a browser.

The Cucumber's Secret (Hard)

45 POINTS OUT OF 75

80.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 66.7%

Abuse unsafe Python pickle data streams in a web application.